

Set Up Your AI Morning Briefing

What you'll build: every morning, Claude reads your calendar and email and sends you a short, friendly summary of your day — before you've even had coffee.

This is one of those setups that sounds like it requires a tech person and actually takes about five minutes. When you're done, you'll wake up to something like: *"Morning! You have 3 things today: dentist for Ella at 2, the school fundraiser form is due (email from PTA last night), and your 10am call moved to 11."*

What you'll need

- The Claude app on your phone or computer (a paid plan)
- A Gmail account and Google Calendar
- Five quiet minutes

The steps

1 Connect your Gmail and Calendar

In the Claude app, open **Settings** → **Connectors** (on some versions it's called "Extensions" or lives under your profile menu). Find **Gmail** and **Google Calendar** and click Connect on each. Google will ask you to sign in and approve — this is the standard Google permission screen, the same one you see when you sign into any app with Google.

Menu names shift a little between app versions — if you don't see "Connectors," look for anything named Settings, Extensions, or Integrations. You're looking for the list of apps Claude can connect to.

2 Ask for a briefing right now — as a test

Before scheduling anything, make sure the connection works. Start a new chat and copy-paste this:

COPY THIS PROMPT Look at my calendar and my unread emails from the last 24 hours. Give me a short morning briefing: today's schedule, anything that needs a reply or action from me, and anything coming up tomorrow I should prep for. Keep it friendly and brief — like a helpful friend, not a report.

Claude will ask permission to read your email and calendar the first time. Say yes, and check that the briefing looks right.

3 Make it automatic

Now the magic part. Send this message:

COPY THIS PROMPT That was great. Please run this exact briefing for me automatically every morning at 7:00am.

Claude sets up a scheduled task, and that's it — you're done. Tomorrow at 7, your briefing arrives on its own.

Make it yours

The prompt is yours to tweak — just tell Claude what to change, in plain English:

- "Also include the weather for [your town]."

- **"Only flag emails from the school or my boss."**
- **"Add one dinner idea based on how busy my evening looks."** (Yes, really.)
- **"On Sundays, give me a preview of the whole week instead."**

Privacy note, mom-to-mom: Connecting Gmail means Claude can read your email to summarize it — same idea as any email app on your phone. You can disconnect it anytime in the same Connectors menu, and it's your account: nobody else (including other family members' devices) gets access.

If something doesn't work

- **Claude says it can't see your email:** the connector isn't connected — go back to step 1.
- **The briefing is too long / too chatty:** reply "shorter, just the essentials" and ask Claude to update the scheduled task.
- **Wrong time:** say "move my morning briefing to 6:30am." Done.

That's the whole lesson. You just automated the mental load of "what's happening today?" — one less thing to hold in your head.